CHAPTER 1:
INTRODUCTION TO THE TOEIC EXAM

A. THEORY

Key Aspects of the TOEIC Test

- Purpose: Evaluates ability to communicate in English within an international workplace environment.
- Test Formats:
  Listening and Reading Test: 2 hours total (approx. 45 min listening, 75 min reading)
  Speaking and Writing Tests: Assesses productive skills.
  TOEIC Bridge®: For beginner to intermediate learners.
- Scoring: Scores range from 10 to 990. No "pass/fail" exists, but rather, performance levels.
- Registration (Indonesia): Conducted through the International Test Center (ITC), often via smartcart.id.
- Preparation: Focus on business-English contexts, daily professional communication, and simulated practice tests.

Structure of TOEIC Listening & Reading

1. Listening (100 questions): Includes photo descriptions, question-response, conversations, and talks.
2. Reading (100 questions): Includes incomplete sentences, text completion, and reading comprehension.
   Validity and Usage
   - Score Validity: Results are valid for two years.
   - Application: Essential for university requirements, corporate recruitment, and career advancement

B. VOCABULARY BUILDER

TOEIC Listening Overview

Duration: ~45 minutes
Total questions: 100
Audio played once only

Part 1 – Photographs (6 questions)
- Look at a photo, listen to **4 statements**
- Choose the statement that best describes the picture
  Skills: visual inference, present continuous, prepositions
  Tip: Focus on **actions and locations**, not objects only.

Part 2 – Question & Response (25 questions)
- One question or statement → **3 responses**

- Choose the most appropriate response
  Skills: understanding WH-questions, indirect responses, common expressions
  Tip: Don't wait for exact words—listen for **meaning**.

Part 3 – Conversations (39 questions)

- Short conversations (2–3 speakers)
- 3 questions per conversation
  Skills: gist, details, speaker intention
- **Tip:** Read questions **before** listening and underline keywords.

Part 4 – Talks (30 questions)

- Monologues (announcements, news, messages)
- 3 questions per talk
  Skills: note-taking, sequencing, purpose
- **Tip:** Identify **who**, **where**, and **why** early.

toeic®

MARKING DIRECTIONS

- Use only pencil
- Darken the circles completely
- Erase cleanly

CORRECT MARK ●

INCORRECT MARKS ✓ ✗ ◒ ⊙

1 NAME

At the arrow, using one box for each letter, print your last (family/surname) name(s) in the first area. If you have more than one last (family/surname) name, leave a space between names. In the second area, print your first (given) name(s). Below each box, fill in the circle containing the same letter. If your name includes any accent marks, fill these in using the circles above the boxes.

2 SEX

○ M
○ F

3 COUNTRY CODE

4 LANGUAGE CODE

5 IDENTIFICATION NUMBER

6 DATE OF BIRTH

MM DD YYYY

7

JOB

ORGANIZATION

CITY

8

TESTING LOCATION

CITY

9

TEST BOOK SERIAL NUMBER

C. PRACTICE

TOEIC Practice - Part 1: Photographs

In Part 1 of the TOEIC you will look at ten photographs. For each photograph you will hear four statements. You will have to choose which statement has the best description of the picture.

Example 1:
Source: TOEIC_Listening Part 1_ Potograph

First you will look at a photograph:

Next you will listen to four statements. Choose the one that best describes what you see in the picture.

Explanation 1:
- Choice A is incorrect because the glasses are on the table. Placement of objects is a common distractor in Part I.
- Choice B is incorrect because the note is on the monitor not the keyboard.
- Choice D is incorrect because the lamp is beside the computer. Prepositions are very common distractors found in Part I. Make sure to review your prepositions of location for the TOEIC.

The correct answer is C.

Transcript:
A) The woman is wearing glasses.
B) There is a note on the keyboard.
C) The woman is facing the monitor.
D) There is a lamp above the computer.

Example 2:
Source: **TOEIC_Listening Part 1_ Potograph_2.mp3**

Explanation 2:

- Choice A is incorrect because the people are wearing life-jackets not coats. Types of clothing are often tested in Part I.
- Choice B is incorrect because the boat is not yet in the water. The people are pulling the boat into the water. When you are analysing a photo make sure that you note the main action that is taking place.
- Choice C is incorrect because the life-jackets are on the people, not in the boat. Be careful not to choose a statement just because you recognize a vocabulary word from the photo.

The correct answer is D.

Transcript:
A) The people are wearing coats.
B) The boat is in the water.
C) The life-jackets are on the boat.
D) The drum is in front of the chair.

Example 3:
Source: **TOEIC_Listening Part 1_ Potograph_3**

Explanation 3:

- Choice B is incorrect because the mountains do not have any snow on them. It is summertime. You may be asked to distinguish between seasons in Part I.
- Choice C is incorrect because the man is wearing a cap. Remember you will not be able to read the choices in this section. Wearing and carrying sound similar. Listen carefully.
- Choice D is incorrect because the sandals are on the man's feet. Both vocabulary words are in the photo, but the context is incorrect.

The correct answer is A.

Transcript:

A) The man is on a pathway.
B) The mountains are covered with snow.
C) The man is carrying a cap.
D) The sandals are in the water.

TOEIC Practice - Part 2: Question-Response

In Part 2 of the TOEIC you will be tested on your ability to respond to a question. It is very important that you can understand and identify wh-questions. You will listen to three possible responses. Only one of the responses is correct.

Example 1:

First you will hear a question. Then you will hear three answer choices.
Source: **TOEIC_Listening Part 1_ Question Response_1.mp3**

Explanation 1:

- Choice A has a distractor called a related word. When you hear the words, "how many" your brain automatically looks for a response with a number in it. This is an error that the test maker expects you to make. Also, the response is in the past tense, but the question asks about the future.
- Choice B is a distractor called a repeated word. The word "coming" is in the question but the answer B does not make sense.This is another common error that the test maker expects you to make.

The correct answer choice is C.
Transcript:

How many people are coming to the conference?

A) There were 70 people there.
B) I don't think she is coming.
C) At least 150 people.

Example 2:
Source : TOEIC_Listening Part 1_ Question Response_2.mp3

Explanation 2:

- Choice A contains related words. The test taker wants you to associate "lunch" with "hamburger and fries". Try not to get tricked this way!
- Choice C is a distractor called similar sounds. The word "boss" sounds similar to the word "bus". This is another common error that you need to watch out for.

The correct answer is B.

Transcript:

Do you think the boss will take us out for lunch today?

A) I had a hamburger and fries.
B) He's probably too busy today.
C) I didn't take the bus.

Example 3:
Source: TOEIC_Listening Part 1_ Question Response_3.mp3

Explanation 3:

- Choice A contains a related word. You might have associated the word "letter" with "type".
- Choice C contains another distractor called a homonym. A homonym is a word that sounds the same but is spelled differently. On the real test you will not be able to read the answer choices. You have to be able to understand which word is which by the context. In this case the homonyms are "fax" and "facts". In the question, "fax" is a verb. In the answer choice it is a noun. You should make a list of all of the homonyms you come across. Here are some more examples:
  week / weak

add / ad
hear / here
knot / not
right / write
weight / wait

The correct answer is B.

Transcript:

Did you fax the letter to the client?

A) I'll type it after lunch.
B) No, I sent it by email.
C) I collected some important facts.

Example 4:
Source: TOEIC_Listening Part 1_ Question Response_4.mp3

Explanation 4:

- Choice B is another common distractor that uses the same word with a different meaning. In the question, the word "long" refers to the amount of time. In the answer choice, the word "long" refers to distance.
- Choice C associates the word "wait" (which could be confused for "weight") with "pounds". The test maker wants to trick you twice!

The correct answer is A.

Transcript:

Did you have to wait very long?

A) No more than an hour.
B) I hate long line-ups.
C) I've gained twenty pounds.

Practice II

SOURCE: TOEIC_Listening_Part_1.mp3

PRACTICE TEST

LISTENING TEST

In the Listening test, you will be asked to demonstrate how well you understand spoken English. The entire Listening test will last approximately 45 minutes. There are four parts, and directions are given for each part. You must mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

Do not write your answers in your test book.

PART 1

Directions:

For each question in this part, you will hear four statements about a picture in your test book. When you hear the statements, you must select the one statement that best describes what you see in the picture. Then find the number of the question on your answer sheet and mark your answer. The statements will not be printed in your test book and will be spoken only one time.

Example:

(source: http://sebgroup.com/imagevault/publishedmedia/2j8frhlvsj60wo7gjlua/_Y4A0535-Edit_4.jpg
Taken on 26 Nov 2016)

You will hear:

(A) A man wears a watch on his left hand
(B) The phone is in the table
(C) The woman is in a ponytail
(D) The man in the middle is the manager

Statement (A), "A man wears a watch on his left hand" is the best description of the picture, so you should select answer (A) and mark it on your answer sheet.

1.

(Sumber: http://www.concorde.edu/blog/medical-laboratory-technician)

2.

(Sumber: http://shushi168.com/business-wallpaper/37169242.html)

3.

(Sumber: https://www.united.com/web/format/img/travel/cabin/business/United-Business-service_1920x750.jpg)

4.

(Sumber: https://fthmb.tqn.com/ZtGAnlgJFtaeQIkjXOH7ylyz2h4=/2121x1414/filters:no_upscale()/about/small-business-GettyImages-583665187-5744b82d3df78c6bb048097f.jpg)

5.

(Sumber: http://www.business.vic.gov.au/__data/assets/image/0003/1051914/SBB_hero_new.jpg)

6.

(Sumber: http://www.right-click-online.com/wp-content/uploads/2016/03/Business-Move.jpg)

7.

(Sumber: http://optima-education.com/wp-content/uploads/2016/05/chef.jpg)

9.

(Sumber: http://ottawa.ca/sites/ottawa.ca/files/paramedic.jpg)

8.

(Sumber: http://www.mpm-motor.co.id/wp-content/uploads/2014/06/kompetisi-safety-riding.jpg)

10.

(Sumber: http://prakashaag986.tumblr.com/)

D. GLOSARIUM

G

Gist (N) : Main idea

D

Distractor (N) : Incorrect option meant to confuse

H

Homonym (N) : Words with same sound, different meaning

P

Productive (skills) (Adj) : Related to language production

Purpose (N) : The reason for doing something

R

Related word (Noun Phrase) : Vocabulary connected in meaning

Repeated word (Noun Phrase) : Word repeated from the question

T

TOEIC (Proper Noun) : A standardized English test for workplace communication

V

Validity (N) : Period during which results are accepted